

CSE 400: Fundamentals of Probability in Computing

Tutorial–2 Lecture Scribe

Q1. Random Point on a Line Segment

Let a point be chosen at a distance x from one end of a segment of length L , where

$$0 < x < L.$$

Two segments are formed: x and $L - x$. Define

$$R = \frac{\min(x, L - x)}{\max(x, L - x)}.$$

We compute $P(R < \frac{1}{4})$.

Case 1: $x \leq \frac{L}{2}$

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{x}{L - x} &< \frac{1}{4} \\ 4x &< L - x \\ 5x &< L \\ x &< \frac{L}{5}.\end{aligned}$$

Case 2: $x > \frac{L}{2}$

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{L - x}{x} &< \frac{1}{4} \\ 4(L - x) &< x \\ 4L - 4x &< x \\ 5x &> 4L \\ x &> \frac{4L}{5}.\end{aligned}$$

Valid region:

$$x \in \left(0, \frac{L}{5}\right) \cup \left(\frac{4L}{5}, L\right).$$

Total valid length:

$$\frac{L}{5} + \frac{L}{5} = \frac{2L}{5}.$$

Since uniform:

$$P = \frac{2L/5}{L} = \frac{2}{5}.$$

Q2. Bayesian Classification with Normal Distributions

White region:

$$X|W \sim N(4, 4), \quad \sigma_1 = 2.$$

Black region:

$$X|B \sim N(6, 9), \quad \sigma_2 = 3.$$

$$P(B) = \alpha, \quad P(W) = 1 - \alpha.$$

Condition:

$$P(B|X = 5) = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Bayes' theorem:

$$P(B|X = 5) = \frac{\alpha f(5|B)}{\alpha f(5|B) + (1 - \alpha) f(5|W)}.$$

Normal density:

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{(x-\mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}}.$$

$$f(5|B) = \frac{1}{3\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-1/18}, \quad f(5|W) = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-1/8}.$$

Substitute:

$$\frac{3\alpha}{3\alpha + 2(1 - \alpha)e^{-5/72}} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Using $e^{-5/72} \approx 0.93$:

$$6\alpha = 3\alpha + 2(1 - \alpha)(0.93).$$

$$3\alpha = 1.86 - 1.86\alpha.$$

$$4.86\alpha = 1.86.$$

$$\alpha \approx 0.3827.$$

Q3. Minimizing Expected Distance

(a) $X \sim \text{Uniform}(0, A)$

$$f_X(x) = \frac{1}{A}.$$

$$E[|X - a|] = \int_0^a (a - x) \frac{1}{A} dx + \int_a^A (x - a) \frac{1}{A} dx.$$

Result:

$$\frac{2a^2 - 2aA + A^2}{2A}.$$

Differentiate:

$$\frac{1}{2A}(4a - 2A) = 0.$$

$$a = \frac{A}{2}.$$

(b) $X \sim \text{Exponential}(\lambda)$

$$f_X(x) = \lambda e^{-\lambda x}.$$

Derivative condition:

$$\frac{d}{da} E[|X - a|] = 1 - 2e^{-\lambda a} = 0.$$

$$e^{-\lambda a} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

$$a = \frac{\ln 2}{\lambda}.$$

Q4. Mixture of Exponentials

$$P(X > t) = p_1 e^{-\lambda_1 t} + p_2 e^{-\lambda_2 t}.$$

$$P(X > t + s) = p_1 e^{-\lambda_1(t+s)} + p_2 e^{-\lambda_2(t+s)}.$$

$$P(X > t + s | X > t) = \frac{p_1 e^{-\lambda_1(t+s)} + p_2 e^{-\lambda_2(t+s)}}{p_1 e^{-\lambda_1 t} + p_2 e^{-\lambda_2 t}}.$$

Q5. Conditional Distribution of Poisson Variables

$$X \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_1), \quad Y \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_2).$$

$$P(X = k | X + Y = n) = \binom{n}{k} \left(\frac{\lambda_1}{\lambda_1 + \lambda_2} \right)^k \left(\frac{\lambda_2}{\lambda_1 + \lambda_2} \right)^{n-k}.$$

Q6. Transformation of Random Variables

$$X \sim \text{Uniform}[-2, 2], \quad f_X(x) = \frac{1}{4}.$$

$$g(x) = \begin{cases} x, & x \in [-2, -1], \\ 0, & x \in (-1, 1), \\ x, & x \in [1, 2]. \end{cases}$$

CDF

$$F_Y(y) = 0, \quad y < -2.$$

$$F_Y(y) = \frac{y+2}{4}, \quad -2 \leq y < -1.$$

$$F_Y(y) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad -1 \leq y < 0.$$

$$P(Y = 0) = \frac{1}{2}.$$

$$F_Y(0) = \frac{3}{4}.$$

$$F_Y(y) = \frac{3}{4}, \quad 0 < y < 1.$$

$$F_Y(y) = \frac{y+2}{4}, \quad 1 \leq y \leq 2.$$

$$F_Y(y) = 1, \quad y > 2.$$

PDF

$$f_Y(y) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad -2 < y < -1.$$

$$f_Y(y) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad 1 < y < 2.$$

$$P(Y = 0) = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Q7. Binomial Stock Model

$$S_{1000} = S_0 u^k d^{1000-k}.$$

Condition:

$$k(\ln u - \ln d) + 1000 \ln d \geq \ln(1.30).$$

$$k \geq 470.$$

$$k \sim \text{Binomial}(1000, 0.52).$$

$$P(k \geq 470) = \sum_{k=470}^{1000} \binom{1000}{k} (0.52)^k (0.48)^{1000-k}.$$

Q8. Exponential Repair Time

$$X \sim \text{Exponential}\left(\frac{1}{2}\right).$$

$$P(X > 2) = e^{-1}.$$

$$P(X \geq 10 | X > 9) = e^{-1/2}.$$

Q9. Distribution of $Z = \sqrt{X^2 + Y^2}$

$$F_Z(z) = \int_{-z}^z \int_{-\sqrt{z^2-x^2}}^{\sqrt{z^2-x^2}} f_X(x) f_Y(y) dy dx.$$

$$f_Z(z) = z \int_{-z}^z \frac{f_X(x) [f_Y(\sqrt{z^2-x^2}) + f_Y(-\sqrt{z^2-x^2})]}{\sqrt{z^2-x^2}} dx.$$

Q10. Joint Distribution of M_n and M_{n+1}

$$M_n = \max(X_1, \dots, X_n).$$

$$P(M_n \leq x) = F(x)^n.$$

Joint CDF:

$$P(M_n \leq x, M_{n+1} \leq y) = \begin{cases} F(x)^n F(y), & x \leq y, \\ F(y)^{n+1}, & x > y. \end{cases}$$